

Executive Summary

LearnLeaf Organizer is a cutting-edge multi-platform application designed to provide students with seamless organization and productivity tools across all platforms. As a web-based solution, it ensures accessibility on desktops, tablets, and mobile devices, while its dedicated Android application mirrors the functionality of the PWA for a consistent user experience.

With an emphasis on simplicity, usability, reliability, and accessibility, LearnLeaf Organizer provides students with an intuitive and personalized way to manage their academic responsibilities, assignments, and schedules; alongside powerful features like LMS integration that are tailored to modern students' needs. By leveraging cloud synchronization and offline capability, users can effortlessly access their data anywhere and be assured of its continuity even in low-connectivity environments.

Background

Today's students navigate an increasingly complex digital landscape where academic information is scattered across multiple platforms. Before LearnLeaf Organizer, students were forced to:

- Manually track assignments across different course websites
- Maintain separate calendars for academic and personal commitments
- Set up independent reminder systems that often failed at critical moments
- Navigate between disconnected tools with inconsistent interfaces

This fragmentation created significant cognitive burden, with studies revealing that **58%** of students submit tasks within 24 hours of deadlines despite having a full week to complete them [1]. Even more concerning, research demonstrates that this last-minute approach directly impacts performance, as **76%** of students who submitted assignments early earned higher scores compared to only 60% of those who procrastinated [1]. The consequences of disorganization aren't just stress—they're reflected in academic outcomes.

Why LearnLeaf Matters

LearnLeaf Organizer addresses the critical organization gap that students themselves identify as their greatest need. By providing a unified academic management system that centralizes all student information in one intuitive platform, LearnLeaf transforms a source of stress into a strategic advantage, helping students meet deadlines confidently and focus on what truly matters: their education.

Experimental Setup

Specifications and Constraints:
The app must organize student tasks by linking them to subjects and projects. It should automate task creation and prioritize tasks based on deadlines. The app must be lightweight, responsive, and user-friendly. Limited to Android Studio for mobile development and Firestore for database management. Must operate efficiently on devices with limited hardware. Ensure data privacy and security by storing only essential user information.

Data Storage Decision:
Flat Structure: All tasks, subjects, and projects stored in a single collection. Simple but lacks scalability.
Hierarchical Structure: Tasks reference subjects and projects; projects reference subjects. This design supports better organization and scalability.

Initial Analysis:
Evaluated existing time management apps (e.g., Notion, MyStudyLife) to identify gaps like steep learning curves and manual task setup. Assessed Firestore's ability to handle hierarchical data for linking tasks, subjects, and projects. Identified the need for automation (e.g., auto-prioritization of tasks) to reduce user input.

Down-Select Justification:
Compared designs using criteria like data organization, scalability, ease of implementation, and user experience. The hierarchical structure was chosen because it scored higher in scalability, logical organization, and future extensibility.

Experimental Test Plan

Core Technologies

The PWA portion of this project utilizes a React.js frontend with a Flask-powered backend for handling API requests. Firebase Firestore ensures real-time data sync, while Google Sign-In simplifies authentication. SendGrid enables automated email notifications, offline functionality is supported through Service Workers, and calendar integration allows iCal syncing with Canvas. An Android app, built with Java in Android Studio, complements the web experience by providing many of the same features, with in-app notifications provided by Firebase Messaging.

Unique Features & Tradeoffs

Designed for seamless cross-platform use, the project offers task prioritization, linking, and a balance between cloud sync and offline storage. It remains cost-efficient as a free or low-cost alternative to premium tools. However, offline functionality requires caching, which may slightly impact initial load times.

Experimental Evaluation

Performance is assessed through load times, sync speeds, and responsiveness. Beta testing evaluates usability, while data collection includes system metrics, surveys, and real-world usage tests. The app is tested under various network conditions, including offline mode and slow connections.

Safety & Risk Assessment

Potential risks include data loss and performance degradation under heavy use. To mitigate these, the system employs regular backups and optimizations to ensure reliability.

Experimental Results

The LearnLeaf Organizer prototype was tested across core modules:

- Task Management:** Users could add, edit, and filter tasks by status, priority, and due dates. Form validation ensured correct input formats.
- Batch Import:** Tasks were successfully imported via a structured input table. Status, priority, and date values followed validation rules.
- Calendar Sync:** Canvas LMS integration imported events correctly using iCal links on a consistent schedule.
- Projects & Subjects:** Tasks were linked and grouped correctly. Donut charts updated in real-time based on task status.
- User Settings:** Time/date formats and preferences were saved and applied consistently across sessions.
- Archive System:** Completed tasks, subjects, and projects were stored and retrieved through a collapsible archive interface.
- Cross-Platform Compatibility:** Deployed on two independent platforms — a browser-based PWA and a native Android app. Both maintained real-time data sync and consistent functionality.

Conclusions

Achievements

Our LearnLeaf Organizer has successfully transformed student task management through:

- Cross-platform cloud synchronization
- Canvas integration for automatic assignment importing
- Customizable notifications with multiple delivery methods
- Enhanced security and data protection

User testing confirmed significant reductions in task management time and improved assignment completion rates, demonstrating LearnLeaf's effectiveness in addressing organizational challenges students face in their academic journeys.

Acknowledgements & Future

We thank Professor Shawn N. Geiser and Steven T. McDermott for their guidance, and the CSE Department at UTA for their support.

Future plans include:

- Enhanced analytics for study pattern insights
- Additional learning management system integrations
- Machine learning for personalized recommendations

References

[1] Elagali, A., Humble, N., Mawson, E., & Fernandez, M. (2021). "Student Procrastination and Academic Performance in Higher Education: The Role of Peer Influence and Social Media Use." Journal of Educational Research and Practice, 11(1), 364-377. <https://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/EJ1293903.pdf>